

FLASHPOINTS & FRAMEWORKS

ARAC INTERNATIONAL WEEKLY GLOBAL SECURITY REVIEW

CONFLICT SYSTEMS • STRATEGIC RISK • RCA/CPS

WEEK ENDING 29 AUGUST 2026

Prepared by ARAC International Inc.

Global Security Analysis & Independent Research

EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT | BLUF

The global security environment during the week ending August 29, 2026 was defined by the continued convergence of conventional conflict, infrastructure disruption, governance weakness, humanitarian stress, and economic coercion.

The most consequential development is increasingly clear: control of territory alone is an insufficient measure of strategic advantage. The capacity to preserve electricity, energy supply, logistics, public health, transportation, communications, commercial distribution, and legitimate governance is becoming equally important.

The Middle East remains the most immediate source of systemic global economic risk. Iran and Oman are working toward an arrangement governing passage through the Strait of Hormuz, while Tehran has publicly attached political and economic conditions to broader reopening. Iran's Revolutionary Guards simultaneously insist that Tehran retains effective control over the waterway. The emerging configuration is therefore not straightforward normalization. It is better understood as movement from near-denial toward negotiated or conditional maritime access. [1][2]

The Democratic Republic of the Congo presents the most serious compound humanitarian-security emergency assessed this week. Ebola has expanded to 60 health zones across six provinces. As of August 26, DRC had recorded 5,794 confirmed cases and 2,786 deaths. At the same time, an important diplomatic counter-signal emerged: the first field ceasefire-verification mission under the Doha framework deployed in South Kivu on August 24. [3][4]

In Ukraine, deep-strike warfare continues moving deeper into logistical and economic systems. A Russian drone strike against a warehouse near Kyiv triggered a major secondary detonation on August 28, killing at least 37 people according to an updated Reuters report. Ukrainian officials also opened negligence investigations concerning explosive storage near residential areas. Earlier Russian strikes devastated Ukrainian food and commercial logistics, while Ukrainian attacks have reduced Russian gasoline production to roughly 70 percent of domestic demand. [5][6][7]

In Sudan, electricity has emerged as a direct stabilization variable. Severe blackouts across army-controlled areas are impeding reconstruction, livelihoods, food preservation, communications, and the return of economic activity. The deterioration demonstrates that battlefield recovery of Khartoum and other areas does not automatically translate into functioning governance. [8]

Taiwan continues strengthening distributed and asymmetric defense. Troops in the strategically located Penghu Islands are preparing for an initial Chinese strike, while Taiwan's legislature approved an alternative six-year drone spending plan after rejecting the government's original procurement structure. [9][10]

Two emerging developments also warrant elevation. Haiti's Kenscoff massacre, in which at least 47 people were killed, demonstrates the continued geographic expansion of gang violence toward strategically important approaches to Port-au-Prince and directly threatens preparations for December elections. [11][12] Meanwhile, Tanzania's vice-presidential resignation represents an unusually visible elite rupture within a political system historically characterized by ruling-party continuity. [13]

Key Judgments

KJ-1 | High Confidence: Strategic competition across multiple theaters is increasingly becoming systems warfare. Energy, logistics, public health, infrastructure, supply chains, financial networks, information systems, and institutional legitimacy are increasingly strategic terrain.

KJ-2 | High Confidence: The Strait of Hormuz remains the highest-impact single-node vulnerability in this week's assessment. A partial reopening would reduce immediate economic pressure but would not eliminate Iran's capacity to use maritime uncertainty as leverage.

KJ-3 | High Confidence: DRC's Ebola epidemic is now inseparable from conflict governance. The launch of a ceasefire-verification mission is a positive indicator, but it remains too early to judge whether diplomatic mechanisms can materially improve humanitarian operating space.

KJ-4 | High Confidence: Russia and Ukraine are increasingly attacking each other's economic-support architecture. Russia retains greater recuperability, but repeated refinery disruption is now producing measurable domestic fuel shortages.

KJ-5 | High Confidence: Sudan demonstrates the difference between territorial control and stabilization. Infrastructure functionality is becoming a more useful indicator of state recovery than battlefield maps alone.

KJ-6 | Moderate-High Confidence: Rovuma LNG remains in a pre-mobilization exposure phase. No new development this week changes the assessment created by approximately \$1.1 billion in pre-investment contract awards on August 17. [14]

KJ-7 | Moderate Confidence: Tanzania has entered an elevated governance-warning period, but evidence is insufficient to assess the vice-presidential resignation as the beginning of broad regime fragmentation.

GLOBAL FLASHPOINT DASHBOARD

Theater	Risk	Trajectory	Primary Driver	180-Day Concern
Middle East / Hormuz	Critical	↔ / ↓	Conditional maritime access, U.S.-Iran coercion	Renewed energy disruption
DRC	Critical	↑	Ebola + armed conflict + governance weakness	Compound health-security emergency
Sudan	Critical	↑	Infrastructure attrition + territorial fragmentation	Failed recovery / institutionalized partition
Ukraine	Critical	↑↑	Deep strikes, logistics and energy warfare	Expanded economic systems attrition
Sahel	Critical	↔ / ↑	Insurgent finance, governance deficit	Coastal West Africa diffusion
Mozambique	High	↑	LNG pre-mobilization + insurgency	Commercial-security exposure
Taiwan Strait	High	↑	Distributed defense + gray-zone coercion	Quarantine / blockade scenario
Ethiopia-Eritrea-Tigray	High	↔	Strategic mistrust, incomplete settlement	Proxy escalation
Haiti	Critical	↑↑	Gang expansion + weak security capacity	Electoral disruption
Tanzania	Moderate-High	↑	Elite rupture + contested governance	Legitimacy crisis

1 | MIDDLE EAST | Hormuz: From Closure Toward Conditional Access

FACT

Iranian security official Mohsen Rezaei said Tehran is preparing conditions for reopening the Strait of Hormuz following requests from mediators. He said Iran and Oman had agreed in principle on a central shipping corridor traversing both countries' waters, but broader implementation would depend upon U.S. actions including sanctions relief and what Tehran describes as an end to the blockade of Iranian ports. [1]

Iran's Revolutionary Guards Navy separately asserted on August 28 that Iran retains full control over the strait and rejected U.S. claims that maritime passage has effectively reopened. [2]

INTERPRETATION

The critical analytical distinction is between physical reopening and strategic normalization.

Iran may not need to stop every vessel to obtain coercive benefit. Selective permissions, unpredictable rules, differentiated access, insurance costs, and the continuing possibility of interdiction allow Tehran to retain strategic leverage.

QAP ANALYTIC JUDGMENT

High Confidence: Hormuz is evolving from a binary open-versus-closed problem into a system of conditional maritime access.

Moderate-High Confidence: A limited arrangement is currently more likely than either complete normalization or unrestricted escalation.

Indicators to Watch

- Published transit procedures
- Increases in tanker and LNG traffic
- Iranian vessel detentions
- U.S. sanctions escalation
- Expansion of alternative Gulf export routes
- Formal Omani guarantees
- Renewed attacks on commercial shipping

Outlook

- 30 Days: Partial transit arrangements are increasingly plausible.
- 90 Days: Maritime traffic could improve without resolving the underlying U.S.-Iran confrontation.
- 180 Days: Gulf states will continue investing in bypass infrastructure, reducing long-term dependence on Hormuz.

2 | DEMOCRATIC REPUBLIC OF THE CONGO | Ebola Expands as the Ceasefire Architecture Moves Into the Field

FACT

WHO reported on August 28 that the Bundibugyo Ebola outbreak has expanded to 60 health zones across six provinces. As of August 26, DRC had recorded 5,794 confirmed cases and 2,786 deaths, a crude case-fatality ratio of 48.1 percent. Ituri remains the epidemic center, followed by North Kivu. [3]

Frontline vaccination has begun, while treatment and surveillance capacity are being expanded. More than 82 percent of identified contacts were reportedly under follow-up as of August 27, which represents a positive response indicator. [3]

A ceasefire-monitoring mission deployed to Minembwe, South Kivu, on August 24 under the Doha peace process between the Congolese government and AFC/M23. The mission represents the first practical field application of the expanded verification architecture. [4]

INTERPRETATION

DRC contains both a severe negative trajectory and an important positive counter-signal.

The Ebola epidemic demonstrates how insecurity, displacement, weak healthcare, public mistrust, and fragmented territorial authority amplify public-health risk. The verification mission, meanwhile, tests whether diplomatic agreements can move from political commitment to observable behavior.

QAP ANALYTIC JUDGMENT

High Confidence: DRC remains a compound conflict-health-governance emergency.

Moderate Confidence: The verification mechanism could become strategically meaningful if it develops routine access, standardized evidence, and political consequences for verified violations.

Low Confidence: There is insufficient evidence to assess the deployment itself as evidence that the broader peace process will hold.

Indicators to Watch

- Weekly rate of new health-zone expansion
- Healthcare-worker infection rates
- Ceasefire-monitor access
- Contact-tracing performance
- Cross-border transmission
- Treatment-center occupancy

Outlook

- 30 Days: Ebola transmission remains elevated while ceasefire monitors test operational access.
- 90 Days: The durability of both epidemiological containment and the Doha mechanism becomes measurable.
- 180 Days: The major strategic question will be whether eastern DRC develops functioning conflict-management institutions or continues relying upon episodic diplomatic intervention.

3 | UKRAINE | Systems Attrition Becomes Increasingly Measurable

FACT

A Russian drone strike against a warehouse in Myla near Kyiv triggered a major detonation on August 28. An updated Reuters report on August 29 placed the death toll at at least 37, with dozens injured and extensive damage to surrounding residential buildings. Ukrainian authorities opened negligence investigations concerning the storage of explosives near civilian areas. [5]

The incident followed repeated Russian attacks on logistics and commercial infrastructure. Ukraine's agriculture minister said recent Russian strikes had destroyed approximately 90 percent of retailers' food-logistics capacity in affected networks. [6]

Ukraine is simultaneously producing measurable effects inside Russia. Reuters reported that gasoline output had fallen to approximately 70 percent of Russian domestic demand after Ukrainian drone strikes forced several large refineries offline. Russia has expanded imports and reinstated fuel-sale restrictions in some regions. [7]

INTERPRETATION

The Russia-Ukraine conflict now contains three increasingly interconnected battles: territorial warfare, military-industrial warfare, and civilian-economic systems warfare.

QAP ANALYTIC JUDGMENT

High Confidence: Ukraine's campaign against Russian refining has crossed from symbolic infrastructure damage into measurable economic disruption.

High Confidence: Russia's campaign against Ukrainian commercial logistics seeks to impose similar network effects.

Moderate Confidence: Neither side is yet close to producing decisive economic paralysis because both retain adaptation capacity.

Indicators to Watch

- Russian refinery repair rates
- Ukrainian logistics redundancy
- Fuel imports and rationing
- Expansion of strikes on transport nodes
- NATO air-defense posture

Outlook

- 30 Days: Continued high-volume attacks against logistics and energy infrastructure.
- 90 Days: Economic endurance becomes increasingly central to strategic assessments.
- 180 Days: Infrastructure warfare becomes a larger driver of European energy, air-defense, insurance, and industrial planning.

4 | SUDAN | Power Infrastructure Exposes the Gap Between Battlefield Success and Stabilization

FACT

Army-controlled areas of Sudan are experiencing extensive electricity outages caused by accumulated infrastructure damage, looting, inadequate repair funding, fuel shortages, and alleged attacks by the RSF. The RSF disputes accusations that it deliberately targeted the grid. [8]

The outages have affected businesses, food storage, household activity, communications, and reconstruction in areas including Khartoum and Omdurman. Sudan's government has responded partly by exempting personal-use solar equipment from customs duties and fees.

INTERPRETATION

The power crisis is not merely a humanitarian consequence. It directly affects the government's capacity to transform military control into legitimate, functioning administration.

Electricity enables water pumping, hospitals, communications, banking, manufacturing, refrigeration, public services, and private-sector recovery.

QAP ANALYTIC JUDGMENT

High Confidence: Sudan's electricity system should be treated as strategic terrain.

High Confidence: SAF territorial gains will produce limited stabilization if essential systems cannot be restored.

Moderate-High Confidence: Distributed solar will improve local resilience but cannot substitute for a functioning national transmission and generation system.

Indicators to Watch

- Attacks on substations and dams
- Grid-repair financing
- Solar adoption
- Hospital electricity availability
- Telecommunications uptime
- Return of businesses
- Fuel prices
- Electricity administration in RSF-controlled territory

Outlook

- 30 Days: Blackouts continue constraining recovery.
- 90 Days: Infrastructure restoration increasingly shapes perceptions of SAF governing competence.
- 180 Days: The functionality of electricity, water, transport, and communications becomes a better measure of stabilization than territorial maps alone.

5 | MOZAMBIQUE | Rovuma LNG Remains a Pre-Mobilization Exposure**FACT**

No development during the current reporting period materially changes last week's assessment.

On August 17, ExxonMobil announced approximately \$1.1 billion in pre-investment contracts associated with Phase 1 of Rovuma LNG in Cabo Delgado. [14]

INTERPRETATION

The absence of another major announcement should not cause the risk assessment to revert downward.

Commercial exposure can begin before FID through contractor positioning, recruitment, transport procurement, warehousing, accommodation, local partnerships, road movements, community negotiations, and security planning.

QAP ANALYTIC JUDGMENT

Moderate-High Confidence: Rovuma LNG remains in a pre-mobilization risk phase.

The principal vulnerability is likely to emerge in the expanding support network around the project rather than the hardened LNG infrastructure itself.

Indicators to Watch

- Contractor positioning
- Recruitment and accommodation demand
- Road and port activity
- Community negotiations
- Security-provider expansion
- Insurgent reconnaissance

Outlook

- 30 Days: Procurement and planning continue.
- 90 Days: Greater contractor visibility and logistics activity are likely.
- 180 Days: Community benefit distribution becomes a critical RCA/CPS indicator of whether investment strengthens or destabilizes local resilience.

6 | SAHEL AND COASTAL WEST AFRICA | Structural Watch: Insurgent Systems Remain Intact

FACT

No development during the last seven days independently crossed ARAC's materiality threshold for the regional assessment.

The threat nevertheless remains Critical. The key structural problem remains that armed organizations such as JNIM operate as more than military formations. Their resilience depends upon financing, kidnapping, taxation, cross-border mobility, local political accommodation, illicit markets, communal grievances, weak public administration, and civilian-protection failures.

INTERPRETATION

The absence of a threshold-crossing event does not imply strategic improvement. It means the conflict system remains dangerous without a clearly verified inflection point this week.

QAP ANALYTIC JUDGMENT

High Confidence: Tactical counterterrorism successes will have limited strategic durability where armed organizations retain financial and governance networks.

Moderate-High Confidence: Benin and Togo should increasingly be understood as the southern edge of the Sahel conflict system rather than separate peripheral theaters.

Indicators to Watch

- JNIM presence near coastal corridors
- Kidnapping revenue
- Militant taxation
- Persistent sanctuary after clearing operations
- Cross-border displacement
- Civilian harm by state forces
- Attacks on commercial transport routes

Outlook

- 30 Days: Persistent high insurgent risk.
- 90 Days: Increased importance of cross-border finance and governance.
- 180 Days: Further Sahel-to-coast integration remains a credible escalation trajectory.

7 | TAIWAN STRAIT | Penghu Clarifies the Logic of Distributed Deterrence

FACT

Taiwanese forces are strengthening readiness on the Penghu Islands, whose location in the Taiwan Strait makes them strategically important in any blockade, invasion, or maritime-control scenario. Exercises involve artillery, anti-ship systems, drones, and preparation for initial Chinese strikes. [9]

Taiwan's opposition-controlled parliament also rejected the government's proposed T\$210 billion drone program but approved an alternative plan allocating T\$240 billion over six years through regular budget mechanisms. [10]

INTERPRETATION

The parliamentary dispute concerns procurement architecture more than the strategic value of unmanned systems.

Taiwan's defense posture increasingly emphasizes distributed strike capability, maritime denial, drones, logistics resilience, continuity of command, dispersed forces, and civilian preparedness.

QAP ANALYTIC JUDGMENT

Moderate-High Confidence: Taiwan is increasingly preparing for a conflict beginning with isolation, precision strike, cyber disruption, and maritime coercion rather than assuming an immediate large-scale amphibious landing.

High Confidence: Resilience is becoming part of deterrence because it reduces the anticipated payoff of a rapid coercive campaign.

Indicators to Watch

- PLA maritime inspection activity
- Large-scale exercises around Penghu
- Drone and anti-ship procurement
- Civil-defense mobilization
- Energy and communications resilience

Outlook

- 30 Days: Continued investment in asymmetric systems.
- 90 Days: Deeper integration of drones and distributed defense.
- 180 Days: Taiwan's strategic focus increasingly shifts from preventing every strike toward remaining functional after the first strike.

8 | ETHIOPIA-ERITREA-TIGRAY | Structural Watch

FACT

No sufficiently corroborated event during the reporting period materially changes the prior assessment.

Risk remains High. The major unresolved variables are incomplete Pretoria implementation, political division within Tigray, Ethiopian-Eritrean strategic mistrust, disputed security arrangements, proxy relationships, and Red Sea access politics.

INTERPRETATION

This is a prevention problem characterized by persistent structural risk rather than a verified new weekly inflection.

QAP ANALYTIC JUDGMENT

Moderate Confidence: Proxy escalation remains more probable in the immediate term than deliberate full-scale Ethiopia-Eritrea war.

Indicators to Watch

- Significant ENDF movement northward
- Eritrean mobilization
- Cross-border incidents
- Collapse of Pretoria mechanisms
- Assab-related escalation
- Credible evidence of direct support to proxies

Outlook

- 30 Days: Elevated but contained tension remains most likely.
- 90 Days: Proxy maneuvering remains the principal escalation pathway.
- 180 Days: Either renewed structured diplomacy or substantially increased military positioning becomes more likely as ambiguity becomes harder to sustain.

EMERGING FLASHPOINT | HAITI | Kenscoff Demonstrates Geographic Expansion of Gang Power

FACT

At least 47 people were killed and 22 injured during an August 23 gang assault on Kenscoff, overlooking Port-au-Prince. The area commands important routes toward Pétion-Ville and the southern approaches to the capital. [11]

The UN told the Security Council on August 28 that nearly 200,000 people had been forcibly returned to Haiti during the first eight months of 2026. Officials warned that gang violence continues to severely constrain preparations for the country's planned December election. [12]

INTERPRETATION

The importance of Kenscoff is geographic as well as humanitarian. Gang expansion into elevated and previously more secure areas creates pressure on the remaining corridors connecting government, diplomatic, commercial, and residential nodes.

QAP ANALYTIC JUDGMENT

High Confidence: Current security conditions remain inconsistent with normal nationwide election administration.

Moderate-High Confidence: Haiti's electoral calendar will increasingly become dependent upon security-force territorial access rather than administrative readiness alone.

Indicators to Watch

- Gang control near Pétion-Ville approaches
- Electoral-site accessibility
- Forced displacement
- Security-force control of transport routes
- Weapons inflows

Outlook

- 30 Days: Severe insecurity continues.
- 90 Days: Election feasibility becomes increasingly tied to territorial access.
- 180 Days: Electoral disruption remains a critical risk if security gains do not precede voting operations.

EMERGING FLASHPOINT | TANZANIA | An Elite Rupture Tests a Historically Stable Political System

FACT

Vice President Emmanuel Nchimbi resigned less than a year after taking office, with his departure effective September 4. President Samia Suluhu Hassan accepted the resignation. [13]

Reuters noted that Nchimbi had recently drawn criticism inside the ruling CCM after advocating a new constitution. His departure follows a contested 2025 election in which a government inquiry found at least 518 people were killed in election-related unrest. [13]

INTERPRETATION

A vice-presidential resignation does not itself establish a regime crisis. Its significance comes from its interaction with contested electoral legitimacy, elite disagreement, constitutional debate, restrictions on political opposition, and memories of post-election violence.

QAP ANALYTIC JUDGMENT

Moderate Confidence: Tanzania has entered an early-warning governance phase.

Low-Moderate Confidence: Available evidence does not yet support a judgment that the CCM is experiencing broad elite fragmentation.

Indicators to Watch

- Additional senior resignations
- Changes in constitutional reform
- Opposition mobilization
- New media restrictions
- Security deployments
- Intra-CCM factional statements
- Political violence

Outlook

- 30 Days: Political consolidation is more likely than immediate mass instability.
- 90 Days: Elite cohesion and constitutional reform become key indicators.
- 180 Days: Tanzania's trajectory will depend on whether political competition remains institutionally managed or increasingly securitized.

CARVER STRATEGIC VULNERABILITY REVIEW

Scale: 1 to 5. Higher scores indicate greater vulnerability. For Recuperability, higher means more difficult or slower recovery.

Strategic System	C	A	R	V	E	Rz	Total
Strait of Hormuz	5	5	5	4	5	5	29/30
Sudan Electricity System	5	4	5	5	5	5	29/30
DRC Ebola Response	5	4	4	5	5	5	28/30
Taiwan Maritime-Energy System	5	4	5	4	5	4	27/30
Ukrainian Logistics System	5	4	4	4	5	4	26/30
Russian Refining Network	5	4	3	4	4	3	23/30
Rovuma Pre-Mobilization Network	4	3	4	4	5	3	23/30

Highest Vulnerability

Hormuz and Sudan's electricity system: 29/30. Hormuz scores highly because of enormous systemic effects and limited near-term substitution. Sudan's grid reaches the same score for a different reason: widespread civilian dependence combined with accumulated physical damage, poor maintenance capacity, difficult recovery, and continuing conflict.

Highest Recuperability

Russia's refining system currently displays greater adaptive capacity through imports, rerouting, repair capability, and industrial depth. Repeated simultaneous disruption, however, is beginning to erode that advantage.

ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS / CONFLICT PREVENTION & STABILIZATION | RCA/CPS

RCA/CPS integrates root-cause diagnosis, Positive Peace systems thinking, prevention strategy, stabilization implications, partnerships, and monitoring into a single analytic framework.

What conditions allow insecurity to reproduce itself, and what changes could alter that causal architecture?

Sudan

The conflict is sustained by fragmented security institutions, center-periphery inequality, military-commercial networks, political exclusion, impunity, external patronage, and institutional collapse.

War damage now creates a reinforcing loop: warfare → infrastructure damage → economic contraction → diminished services → declining legitimacy → weakened recovery → prolonged instability.

Electricity, water, communications, healthcare, transportation, markets, and governance restoration must be treated as stabilization activities rather than post-conflict technical projects.

DRC

The Ebola emergency and eastern conflict interact through weak territorial administration, armed-group governance, regional competition, displacement, healthcare deficits, and low institutional trust.

Public health, community engagement, security for responders, local governance, ceasefire verification, and regional diplomacy need to function as one stabilization architecture.

Critical insight: Trust is not merely a communications objective. In an epidemic, trust is operational infrastructure.

Mozambique

The structural drivers remain exclusion, youth unemployment, weak justice institutions, uneven distribution of resource benefits, weak state reach, and insurgent exploitation of grievance.

LNG-related investment should be linked visibly to employment, infrastructure, education, justice, services, local participation, and transparent benefit distribution.

A secure LNG compound surrounded by unresolved community vulnerability would represent tactical security without strategic stabilization.

Sahel

The regional conflict system combines rural governance deficits, corruption, communal competition, illicit markets, political exclusion, civilian harm, insurgent finance, and cross-border sanctuary.

Military operations must be connected to civilian protection, legitimate local governance, counter-finance mechanisms, justice, accountable security institutions, and regional cooperation.

Territory cleared but not governed remains contested terrain.

Ethiopia-Eritrea-Tigray

This remains primarily a prevention problem.

Maintain channels for dispute management, monitor military posture, prevent proxy activation, and preserve mechanisms associated with the Pretoria settlement before deterioration produces renewed interstate or large-scale internal conflict.

Prevention remains substantially less costly than stabilization after renewed war.

Ukraine

Ukraine is fundamentally an interstate conflict and should not be reduced to a fragility framework.

Its stabilization implications nevertheless include infrastructure resilience, reconstruction, displaced-population reintegration, institutional continuity, economic recovery, and accountable governance.

Protect civilian systems during war to reduce the scale and cost of post-war stabilization.

Taiwan

Taiwan demonstrates prevention through resilience.

Strengthen energy, communications, command continuity, transportation, cyber resilience, civil defense, distributed logistics, and economic continuity.

The strategic objective is to make coercion incapable of producing rapid political paralysis.

Hormuz

The underlying architecture includes U.S.-Iran rivalry, sanctions, maritime coercion, competing security concepts, proxy relationships, and nuclear tensions.

The immediate prevention objective is not comprehensive reconciliation.

It is a limited and credible maritime regime capable of preventing a tactical incident from producing strategic escalation.

Haiti

The conflict system combines weak state institutions, armed-group territorial control, illicit arms flows, economic deprivation, displacement, corruption, and limited policing capacity.

Election security must not be treated as a temporary protective operation.

It requires sustainable territorial governance, police capacity, justice mechanisms, community legitimacy, arms interdiction, and economic access.

Tanzania

Tanzania remains a prevention case rather than a stabilization case.

Preserve legitimate political competition, constitutional mechanisms, media space, credible elite dispute resolution, and restraint in security responses.

The objective is to prevent political competition from becoming structurally securitized.

RCA/CPS Cross-Theater Judgment

Fragility becomes strategically dangerous when disruption accumulates faster than legitimate institutions and communities can absorb, adapt, and recover.

This explains why an electrical grid in Sudan, an Ebola treatment system in Congo, a refinery in Russia, a warehouse in Ukraine, a shipping channel at Hormuz, a gang-controlled road in Haiti, or a communications network in Taiwan can all become strategic terrain.

Security is therefore not simply control. Security is continuity of legitimate function.

SIGNALS, ESCALATION & MISCALCULATION DASHBOARD

Indicator	Theater	Likelihood	Impact
Formal Hormuz corridor implemented	Middle East	Moderate-High	High positive
Renewed attack on major tanker	Middle East	Moderate	Critical
Ebola expands beyond 60 health zones	DRC	High	Critical
Ceasefire monitors gain routine access	DRC	Moderate	High positive
Major attack on Sudan power infrastructure	Sudan	Moderate-High	Critical
Russian gasoline deficit deepens	Russia	Moderate-High	High
Physical Rovuma mobilization	Mozambique	High	High
JNIM consolidates coastal corridor	Sahel	Moderate-High	High
Chinese quarantine or inspection regime	Taiwan	Moderate	Critical
Additional senior CCM rupture	Tanzania	Low-Moderate	High
Gang control expands around Pétion-Ville approaches	Haiti	High	Critical

Analyst's Notebook

Key Assumptions

- Washington and Tehran currently prefer coercive bargaining to unrestricted war.
- Iran considers maritime access a negotiating asset.
- DRC's Ebola trajectory remains sensitive to insecurity and public trust.
- Ceasefire monitoring alone cannot resolve the DRC-M23 conflict.
- Russia retains substantial industrial recuperability despite growing fuel disruption.
- Sudan's recovery will remain constrained by infrastructure failure.
- Rovuma LNG continues progressing toward FID.
- Beijing continues favoring coercive pressure below the major-war threshold.
- Tanzania's vice-presidential resignation does not yet represent generalized ruling-party fragmentation.

Alternative Hypotheses

- Hormuz: Current diplomacy could yield faster normalization than assessed.
- DRC: Expanded vaccination, treatment, and contact tracing could produce a turning point during the next several weeks.
- Ukraine/Russia: Fuel shortages may remain economically significant without producing material battlefield effects.
- Sudan: Distributed solar and localized infrastructure repair could produce faster socioeconomic recovery than national-grid indicators imply.
- Tanzania: Nchimbi's resignation may remain an isolated elite dispute without broader political consequences.

Priority Intelligence Gaps

- Exact rules for Hormuz transit
- Ebola transmission rates by conflict-control area
- Frequency and independence of DRC ceasefire verification
- Sudan power-grid repair timelines
- Russian refinery repair rates and military fuel prioritization
- Physical timing of Rovuma contractor mobilization
- JNIM current revenue composition

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- PLA decision thresholds for blockade-like operations
- CCM elite cohesion
- Haiti's measurable election-security benchmarks

STRATEGIC OUTLOOK | 30 / 90 / 180 Days

30-Day Outlook

The most likely global condition is high-intensity but compartmentalized instability.

Hormuz moves cautiously toward a negotiated maritime arrangement.

DRC's Ebola epidemic continues expanding while containment capacity improves.

Ukraine and Russia sustain reciprocal infrastructure warfare.

Sudan struggles to convert military control into economic and institutional recovery.

Rovuma LNG moves deeper into preparatory exposure.

Haiti faces severe election-security constraints.

Tanzania undergoes political consolidation following the vice-presidential rupture.

Confidence: High.

90-Day Outlook

The central analytical question will be whether temporary adaptations begin to institutionalize.

Hormuz could develop an enduring conditional-access system.

DRC's ceasefire-monitoring mechanism will either develop credibility or join earlier failed diplomatic architectures.

Ebola may enter measurable containment or become a prolonged regional emergency.

Russia and Ukraine will further adapt their economies to infrastructure warfare.

Rovuma LNG may move materially closer to execution.

Haiti's ability to conduct meaningful elections will become increasingly dependent upon territorial security rather than administrative planning.

Most Likely Global Condition: Prolonged Competitive Instability.

Confidence: Moderate-High.

180-Day Outlook

Scenario 1 | Managed Competitive Instability

Estimated likelihood: 50%

Major conflicts persist, but deterrence, economic adaptation, diplomacy, and risk aversion prevent simultaneous systemic escalation.

Scenario 2 | Cascading Regional Escalation

Estimated likelihood: 30%

A major Hormuz incident, Taiwan maritime confrontation, Sudanese infrastructure collapse, Ethiopia-Eritrea escalation, Sahel spillover event, DRC deterioration, or Haitian electoral-security crisis generates effects beyond its originating theater.

Scenario 3 | Selective De-escalation

Estimated likelihood: 20%

Hormuz traffic stabilizes, DRC ceasefire monitoring gains credibility, Ebola transmission declines, and selected political-security processes improve without producing comprehensive conflict resolution.

Scenario probabilities are structured analytic estimates, not statistical forecasts.

BOTTOM LINE

The week's most important strategic lesson is not found in any single battlefield.

It is found in the infrastructure that connects battlefield outcomes to political power.

Electricity in Sudan.

Fuel in Russia.

Warehouses and food distribution in Ukraine.

Hospitals and community trust in DRC.

Shipping lanes at Hormuz.

Ports, contractors, and roads in Cabo Delgado.

Distributed defenses in Taiwan.

Transport corridors in Haiti.

These systems determine whether military action produces political effect.

Conflict prevention begins before violence dominates a system, and stabilization begins before the shooting stops.

The most resilient actors will not necessarily be those capable of preventing every disruption. They will be those capable of maintaining legitimate function, adapting under pressure, recovering faster than adversaries can impose costs, and retaining public confidence during the process.

That is increasingly the strategic terrain of the global security environment.

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Analytic Note

Facts are attributed to cited sources. Interpretations, Key Judgments, QAP assessments, CARVER scores, RCA/CPS findings, indicators, confidence levels, alternative hypotheses, scenario probabilities, and outlooks are ARAC International analytic judgments. Confidence reflects the quality, consistency, corroboration, relevance, and timeliness of available evidence. It does not represent certainty.

Where no priority theater crossed the weekly materiality threshold, the assessment remains on structural watch rather than manufacturing a development to preserve newsletter symmetry.